because (ideally) every function can (and should) only implement a single responsibility (or a single action/algorithm, if you prefer).

Take, for instance, the code in section A.4.2 above that computes the GCD of two numbers: we can easily refactor it into a function

```
function gcd(a, b)
  while a <> b do
    if a > b then
      a ← a – b
    else
      b ← b – a
  return a
```

Notice, among other things, how now it is immediately clear where the final result is stored – the best part is, the caller doesn't even have to worry about it, because the function takes care of returning the right value. Moreover, variables `a` and `b` only exist inside function `gcd`, and therefore anything happening inside the body of this function won't influence the rest of the code.

A.6.1 Overloading and default arguments

Function's arguments can have default values.

```
function f(a, b=2)
  return a * b^2
```